

Parts of Speech

The Adjective

- Read the following sentences:
- 1. Iqra is a clever girl. (Girl of *What kind*)
- 2. I don't like *that* boy. (*Which boy*)
- 3. He gave me *five* apples. (*How many*)
- 4. There is *little time* for preparation. (*How much time*)
- An **adjective** modifies a noun or a pronoun by **describing, identifying, or quantifying** words. An adjective usually precedes the noun or the pronoun which it modifies.

- **Examples**

- The **truck-shaped** balloon floated over the treetops.
- Mrs. Morrison papered her **kitchen** walls with **hideous** wall paper.
- The **small** boat foundered on the **wine dark** sea.
- The **coal** mines are **dark** and **dank**.
- **Many** stores have already begun to play **irritating Christmas** music.
- The back room was filled with **large, yellow** rain boots.
- The Prime Minister, **accompanied by his ten ministers**, leaves for The US. (Non-restrictive Clause)
- The person **that you are talking about** is not here today. (Restrictive)
- Restrictive (that)
- Non-restrictive (which)

- An adjective can be modified by an adverb, or by a phrase or clause functioning as an adverb. In the sentence
- My husband knits intricately **patterned** mittens.
for example, the adverb "intricately" modifies the adjective "patterned."
- Some nouns, many pronouns, and many participle phrases can also act as adjectives. In the sentence
- Ali listened to the **muffled** sounds of the radio **hidden** under her pillow.
for example, both **highlighted** adjectives are past participles.
- Grammarians also consider **articles** ("the," "a," "an") to be adjectives.

- A **possessive adjective** ("my," "your," "his," "her," "its," "our," "their") is similar or identical to a possessive pronoun; however, it is used as an adjective and modifies a noun or a noun phrase, as in the following sentences:
- I can't complete **my** assignment because I don't have the textbook.
In this sentence, the possessive adjective "my" modifies "assignment" and the noun phrase "my assignment" functions as an object.

Note that the possessive pronoun form "mine" is not used to modify a noun or noun phrase.

- What is **your** phone number.

Here the possessive adjective "your" is used to modify the noun phrase "phone number"; the entire noun phrase "your phone number" is a subject complement.

Note that the possessive pronoun form "yours" is not used to modify a noun or a noun phrase.

- The bakery sold **his** favourite type of bread.

In this example, the possessive adjective "his" modifies the noun phrase "favourite type of bread" and the entire noun phrase "his favourite type of bread" is the direct object of the verb "sold."

Types of Adjectives

- The **demonstrative adjectives** "this," "these," "that," "those," and "what" are identical to the demonstrative pronouns, but are used as adjectives to modify nouns or noun phrases, as in the following sentences:

- When the librarian tripped over **that** cord, she dropped a pile of books.

In this sentence, the demonstrative adjective "that" modifies the noun "cord" and the noun phrase "that cord" is the object of the preposition "over."

- Even though my friend preferred **those** plates, **I bought these**.

In the subordinate clause, "those" modifies "plates" and the noun phrase "those plates" is the object of the verb "preferred." In the independent clause, "these" is the direct object of the verb "bought."

- An **interrogative adjective** ("which" or "what") is like an interrogative pronoun, except that it modifies a noun or noun phrase rather than standing on its own (see also demonstrative adjectives and possessive adjectives):

- **Which** plants should be watered twice a week?

Like other adjectives, "which" can be used to modify a noun or a noun phrase. In this example, "which" modifies "plants" and the noun phrase "which plants" is the subject of the compound verb "should be watered":

- **What** book are you reading?

In this sentence, "what" modifies "book" and the noun phrase "what book" is the direct object of the compound verb "are reading."

- An **indefinite adjective** is similar to an indefinite pronoun, except that it modifies a noun, pronoun, or noun phrase, as in the following sentences:
- **Many** people believe that corporations are under-taxed.
The indefinite adjective "many" modifies the noun "people" and the noun phrase "many people" is the subject of the sentence.
- I will send you **any** mail **that arrives after you have moved to London**.
The indefinite adjective "any" modifies the noun "mail" and the noun phrase "any mail" is the direct object of the compound verb "will send."

Exercise

- **Pick out the adjectives.**

1. The ship sustained heavy damage.
2. I have called several times.
3. Every dog has his day.
4. What time is it.
5. Give me that blue water bottle.
6. This time I won't fail you.
7. I want those gorgeous marbles.
8. These mangoes are rotting.
9. Which pen do you prefer?
10. Whose book was that?

The Adverb

- An **adverb** can modify a **verb, an adjective, another adverb, a phrase, or a clause**. An adverb indicates manner, time, place, cause, or degree and answers questions such as "how," "when," "where," "how much".
- While some adverbs can be identified by their characteristic "ly" suffix, **most of them must be identified by untangling the grammatical relationships within the sentence or clause as a whole**. Unlike an adjective, an adverb can be found in various places within the sentence.

- In the following examples, each of the **highlighted** words is an adverb:

- The seamstress **quickly** made the mourning clothes.

In this sentence, the adverb "quickly" modifies the verb "made" and indicates in what manner (or how fast) the clothing was constructed.

- The midwives waited **patiently** through a long labour.

Similarly in this sentence, the adverb "patiently" modifies the verb "waited" and describes the manner in which the midwives waited.

- The **boldly** spoken words would return to haunt the rebel.

In this sentence the adverb "boldly" modifies the adjective "spoken."

- **Unfortunately**, the bank closed at three **today**.

- In this example, the adverb "unfortunately" modifies the entire sentence.

Conjunctive Adverbs

- You can use a **conjunctive adverb** to join two clauses together. Some of the most common conjunctive adverbs are "also," "consequently," "finally," "furthermore," "hence," "however," "incidentally," "indeed," "instead," "likewise," "meanwhile," "nevertheless," "next," "nonetheless," "otherwise," "still," "then," "therefore," and "thus." A conjunctive adverb is *not* strong enough to join two independent clauses without the aid of a semicolon.

- The **highlighted** words in the following sentences are conjunctive adverbs:
- The government has cut university budgets; **consequently**, class sizes have been increased.
- He did not have all the ingredients the recipe called for; **therefore**, he decided to make something else.
- The report recommended several changes to the ways the corporation accounted for donations; **furthermore**, it suggested that a new auditor be appointed immediately.
- The crowd waited patiently for three hours; **finally**, the doors to the stadium were opened.
- Batman and Robin fruitlessly searched the building; **indeed**, the Joker had escaped through a secret door in the basement.

Conjunctions (Co-ordinating, Sub-ordinating)

- You can use a **conjunction** to link words, phrases, and clauses, as in the following example:
- I ate the pizza **and** the pasta.
- Call the movers **when** you are ready.
- When you are ready, call the movers.

- **Co-ordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS)**
- You use a **co-ordinating conjunction** ("and," "but," "or," "nor," "for," "so," or "yet") to join individual words, phrases, and independent clauses.
- In the following sentences, each of the **highlighted** words is a co-ordinating conjunction:
- Lilacs **and** violets are usually purple.
- This movie is particularly interesting to feminist film theorists, **for** the screenplay was written by Mae West.

- A **subordinating conjunction** introduces a dependent clause and indicates the nature of the relationship among the independent clause(s) and the dependent clause(s).
- The most common subordinating conjunctions are "after," "although," "as," "because," "before," "how," "if," "once," "since," "than," "that," "though," "till," "until," "when," "where," "whether," and "while."
- **After** she had learned to drive, Alice felt more independent. (complex sentence)
- **If** the paperwork arrives on time, your cheque will be mailed on Tuesday.
- Ahmad had to begin his thesis over again **when** his computer crashed.

Correlative conjunctions

- **Correlative conjunctions** always appear in pairs -- you use them to link equivalent sentence elements. The most common correlative conjunctions are "both...and," "either...or," "neither...nor," "not only...but also," "so...as," and "whether...or."
- **Both** my grandfather **and** my father worked in the steel Mill.
- She is **both** intelligent **and** beautiful.
- I will **either** go for a hike **or** stay home and watch TV.
- Jerry is **neither** rich **nor** famous.
- He is **not only** intelligent, **but also** very funny.
- The explosion destroyed **not only** the school **but also** the neighbouring pub.

Exercise

- **Use the adverb and the correct form of the verbs in brackets.
Use contractions where possible.**
- Our teacher, Mrs Jones, (never /be) late for lessons.
- I (often /clean) my bedroom at the weekend.
- My brother(hardly ever/help) me with my homework.
- I (sometimes /be) bored in the maths lessons.
- We (rarely /watch) football on TV.
- You and Tony (never / play) computer games with me.
- You (usually /be) at the sports centre on Sunday.
- The school bus (always/arrive) at half past eight.

Questions?